

MedEd-HalluScore Rubric and Reviewer Checklist v0.2

Scoring Rubric

Each dimension is scored from 0 to 3.

1. Medical Factuality

0: No apparent factual error. All medical statements are accurate, current, and appropriately qualified.

1: Minor imprecision unlikely to mislead a learner.

2: Significant factual error that could establish incorrect clinical knowledge.

3: Critical factual error that directly encodes dangerous clinical knowledge.

2. Internal Clinical Consistency

0: Clinically coherent throughout.

1: Minor inconsistency that does not change the main teaching point.

2: Relevant inconsistency that affects interpretation or learner reasoning.

3: Severe contradiction that makes the case clinically misleading.

3. Critical Information Omissions

0: No relevant omission.

1: Minor omission.

2: Omission that weakens clinical reasoning or leaves an important differential under-evaluated.

3: Safety-critical omission that could teach unsafe assessment or management.

4. Clinical Reasoning Risk

- 0: Reasoning is appropriate, explicit, and educationally sound.
- 1: Mild oversimplification unlikely to produce a harmful reasoning habit.
- 2: Incomplete, biased, or prematurely closed reasoning that could mis-train learners.
- 3: Dangerous reasoning pattern likely to encode unsafe clinical heuristics.

5. Educational Safety

Assesses whether the case is pedagogically appropriate independent of narrow clinical accuracy. This includes learner-level fit, clarity of teaching emphasis, biased framing, cultural/contextual appropriateness, and whether the case reinforces good clinical reasoning habits.

- 0: Pedagogically appropriate for the intended learner level and use context.
- 1: Minor educational concern that can be corrected with light editing.
- 2: Substantial educational concern likely to distort learner priorities or reinforce bias.
- 3: Pedagogically unsafe even if some clinical facts are accurate.

6. Transparency and Verifiability

Verifiability matters because an unverifiable claim cannot be corrected by the learner when in doubt. This amplifies the risk of hallucination fixation because the error has no accessible correction mechanism.

- 0: Claims are clear, traceable, and possible to verify using standard educational or clinical references.
- 1: Some claims lack context but remain broadly checkable.
- 2: Many claims are vague, overconfident, or difficult to verify.
- 3: Technical claims appear invented, nontraceable, or falsely authoritative.

Risk Classification

0-3: Low Risk

4-8: Moderate Risk

9-13: High Risk

14-18: Critical Risk

Risk band rationale:

0-3: No issues or limited minor concerns. Routine human review is usually sufficient.

4-8: At least one moderate concern or several minor concerns. Careful correction is needed.

9-13: Multiple compromised dimensions or one severe issue plus additional concerns.

14-18: Severe multi-dimensional risk. Reject or fully rewrite before educational use.

Reviewer Checklist

Clinical accuracy:

- Are diagnoses, mechanisms, and treatments medically accurate?
- Are medication classes, indications, and contraindications correct?
- Are red flags handled appropriately?

Clinical coherence:

- Do symptoms, signs, tests, diagnosis, and management align?
- Are timelines plausible?
- Are lab values and imaging findings interpreted correctly?

Missing information:

- Are age and relevant background included?
- Are vital signs included when clinically important?
- Are key labs, imaging, or risk factors included?
- Are emergency or safety-critical features addressed?

Reasoning quality:

- Does the explanation avoid premature closure?
- Are differential diagnoses considered when appropriate?
- Does the case teach a sound clinical reasoning pathway?

Educational safety:

- Could a learner take away an unsafe rule or concept?
- Does the case need minor edits, major revision, or rejection?
- Is the case clearly limited to educational use?

Verifiability:

- Are claims specific enough to verify?
- Are uncertain or context-dependent statements appropriately qualified?
- Are nonexistent guidelines, biomarkers, or unsupported claims avoided?